

LinkedIn Content Strategy

Volopay Growth Squad Assessment | July 2026

Task 1 – LinkedIn Content Strategy

Growth Squad Assessment | Finance Audience Series

Post 1 — Target Audience: CFO

Why This Topic Matters

CFOs are under pressure to do more with less — tighter forecasts, board-level scrutiny on cash flow, and the constant tension between growth and cost control. The real problem isn't a lack of data; it's a lack of visibility at the right moment. This post addresses a strategic blind spot most CFOs I've spoken to privately acknowledge: that financial close cycles are still hiding cash inefficiencies that sit in plain sight on the vendor side.

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The biggest cash flow leak in most companies isn't in the P&L. It's in the gap between invoice approval and payment.

I've seen \$200M+ revenue companies with finance teams that could tell you their EBITDA to three decimal places — but couldn't tell you how much early payment discount they left on the table last quarter.

That's not a data problem. It's a visibility problem.

Here's what the gap typically looks like:

- Vendor sends invoice on Day 1
- Invoice sits in an inbox for 5–7 days before anyone touches it
- Approval takes another 3–5 days across departments
- Payment is finally released on Day 45–60
- The 2/10 net 30 discount? Gone.

At scale, this adds up. For a company running \$50M in annual payables, a 2% early payment discount across even 30% of invoices is \$300,000 sitting uncaptured every year.

The CFOs I've seen get this right aren't necessarily spending more — they've just redesigned the sequence. Approval flows are restructured to catch discount windows. Treasury is looped in earlier. The AP team has clear escalation signals, not just due dates.

Two things I'd push any finance leader to audit this quarter:

What's your average invoice-to-approval cycle time? If you don't know it off the top of your head, that's the first signal.

Do your teams have visibility into which vendors offer early payment terms? Most don't, unless someone manually maintains it.

Operational finance is where strategy either shows up — or doesn't.

What's your current average AP cycle time, and have you found a way to make it faster without adding headcount?

Post 2 — Target Audience: Finance Manager

Why This Topic Matters

Finance Managers live in the middle: they're accountable to the CFO for numbers that depend on systems and workflows they only partially control. Month-end close is often their most stressful deliverability — and most of the friction isn't accounting complexity, it's coordination overhead. This post speaks directly to that experience.

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Month-end close shouldn't feel like a fire drill every single time. But for most finance teams, it still does.

Here's what a typical close looks like from the inside:

Day 28: Chasing department heads for accruals

Day 29: Three versions of the same spreadsheet floating around

Day 30: Realizing one entity's intercompany entries were posted wrong

Day 31: Someone submits a late PO and expects it to make the books

Day 1–2 (next month): Leadership wants variance commentary "by EOD"

The irony is that most finance managers I know are genuinely good at the accounting. The chaos isn't about competency — it's about the system.

A few things I've seen actually move the needle:

1. Lock the accrual submission deadline three days before close, not the day of.

Departments will always push to the last minute. If the deadline is Day 30, make Day 27 the functional deadline. You'll still get stragglers, but you'll have room to breathe.

2. Build a close checklist that's visible to everyone, not just your team.

When department heads can see which tasks are pending and who owns them, the "I forgot" conversations mostly disappear.

3. Separate your reconciliation work from your close commentary work.

Trying to do both simultaneously under a deadline is where errors sneak in. If you can finish recs by Day 2 and commentary by Day 4, the quality goes up significantly.

The companies I've seen cut their close cycle from 8 days to 4 days didn't do it through technology alone. They did it by redesigning the coordination model first, then layering tools on top.

What's your current close cycle length, and where does it usually get stuck?

Post 3 — Target Audience: Accounts Payable Team

Why This Topic Matters

AP teams are the operational backbone of a company's vendor relationships, but they're often treated as a processing function rather than a strategic one. This post validates their real impact and gives practical framing for how AP teams can handle a common, stressful scenario: dealing with duplicate invoices and vendor payment disputes without creating friction or legal exposure.

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AP teams handle thousands of transactions a month. It only takes one duplicate payment to create a vendor relationship problem, a reconciliation headache, and a conversation nobody wants to have.

Let me talk about how to handle the three most common pain points I hear from people in accounts payable:

1. Duplicate Invoice Detection

Vendors sometimes submit the same invoice twice — sometimes intentionally, sometimes because their system auto-retries. The catch? Duplicates don't always look identical. Same amount, different invoice number. Same invoice number, slightly different date.

What helps:

- Always run a match on vendor + amount + date range before approving, not just invoice number
- Flag anything within ± 5 days and $\pm \$50$ of an existing open item for human review

- Build a standard vendor response template for when you catch one — don't escalate, just document and resolve
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2. Vendor Escalations on Overdue Invoices

Vendors will call. Some will be aggressive. Here's how to handle it without burning the relationship:

- Pull the invoice status before picking up the phone — "let me check" with no information ready is frustrating for everyone
 - If payment is genuinely delayed, give a specific date, not "soon" or "in process"
 - Document every verbal commitment in a follow-up email, even a one-liner — it protects you and gives the vendor closure
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3. Three-Way Matching Under Pressure

When there's a backlog, three-way matching (PO → GRN → Invoice) gets sloppy. The shortcut — approving without checking — creates problems downstream that take 10x longer to fix.

A practical rule: if the match is off by more than 5%, escalate before approving, not after. It feels slower in the moment, but it prevents month-end surprises.

AP isn't just processing. It's risk management in real time.

What's one workflow fix that's genuinely made your AP process more reliable? I'd love to hear what's actually worked.

Assessment prepared by: [Candidate Name] | Growth Squad Role | July 2026